

COMPOSITION FLUENCY

Plan zones before writing. Revise existing melodies. Compose complete multi-section songs using the full AMF framework at full speed.

4
WEEKS

PHASE 3: THE FRAMEWORK DISAPPEARS

The goal of Phase 3 is for the framework to become invisible. By Day 90, you shouldn't be thinking "what zone is this note?" — you should be *hearing* the zone before you even name it. The drills in this phase push you to use all 8 modules together in real composition time, so the instinct gets reinforced under the pressure of actually writing music.

WEEK 9 · DAYS 61-67

SWEET VS BITTER BALANCE

Score your phrases — aim for section-appropriate zone ratios

D61-62 Score Your Own Phrases

Take 3 phrases you've composed in Phases 1-2. Count how many notes are in each zone. Compute the percentage: Zone 1 / Zone 2 / Zone 3 / Zone 4. Compare to the Reference Ratios on Sheet 6A. Is your verse-level phrase verse-appropriate?

ANALYSIS

D63-64 Section Targeting

Compose 3 phrases to hit specific zone ratios: one "verse" phrase (50% Sweet), one "chorus" phrase (60% Sweet + big peak), one "bridge" phrase (heavy Zone 3 and 4 = floating + bitter). Don't just count after — plan the zones before you write the notes.

COMPOSE

D65-67 Contrast Two Sections

Write a verse AND a chorus for the same song concept. The chorus should have a noticeably higher Zone 1 ratio and the highest note should be a chord tone. Make them feel like they belong together but serve different emotional purposes.

COMPOSE

WEEK 10 · DAYS 68-74

TENSION ARC PLANNING

Map the emotional arc before writing a note

D68-69 Fill the Section Planner

Use Sheet 7A to plan a 4-section song: Intro / Verse / Chorus / Bridge. For each section: target zone, target pillar note, zone distribution goal. Write the plan BEFORE composing. Then spend 5 min writing just the verse melody from the plan.

COMPOSE

D70-71 The Bridge Challenge

The bridge is where most writers fail — it either feels too similar to the verse or sounds random. Compose a bridge that is predominantly Zone 3 (Floating) and Zone 4 (Bitter). It should feel like it comes from a different emotional place, then lead back to the final chorus.

COMPOSE

D72-74 Analyze a Complete Song

Choose a song with verse, chorus, and bridge. Map the zone arc for each section's opening phrase. Does the composer follow or break the Classic Rise-Fall arc? Write one paragraph on what makes the tension arc work in this song.

ANALYSIS

WEEK 11 · DAYS 75-81

THE REVISION CHECKLIST

Run the 8-step audit on real melodies — yours and others'

D75-76 Audit a Melody You've Written

Take a melody you've written (from any point in this plan) and run it through all 8 steps of the Melody Revision Checklist (Sheet 8A). Identify: at least one thing to fix. Make the fix. Sing both versions. Hear the improvement.

ANALYSIS

D77-78 Find the Red Flags

Using the red-flag checklist from Sheet 8A, check your last 5 composed phrases for: 3+ consecutive Zone 4 notes, chorus ending on TI or FA, zero Zone 3/4 notes (too safe). Fix any that have a red flag. One fix per session.

DRILL

D79-81 Peer Melody Audit

Find a melody from a published song and run the full 8-step audit as if you were giving the writer feedback. Identify 2 things that are deliberate and effective (explain why using AMF language). Identify 1 thing you would change.

ANALYSIS

WEEK 12 · DAYS 82-90

FULL SONG + FINAL ASSESSMENT

Compose a complete song using the full framework — then prove you don't need it

D82-85 The 90-Day Song

Compose a complete original song: Intro / Verse / Pre-Chorus / Chorus / Bridge / Final Chorus. Use the Section Planner. Plan your zone arcs, pillar notes, and zone distribution for each section first. Then write. This is your capstone piece.

COMPOSE

D86-87 Audit Your Own Song

Run the full 8-step Melody Revision Checklist on your 90-Day Song. Fix at least 2 things. Specifically check: does the chorus really feel more resolved than the verse? Does the bridge have enough zone contrast?

REVIEW

D88 Speed Drill: Full Framework

90-second timed drill. Call out 20 random scenarios: "RE over G7 — chord tone? Zone?" Answer before thinking. If any answer takes more than 2 seconds, you've found your last weak spot. Spend the remaining session time on it.

DRILL

D89 Sweet Home Chicago: Final Full Analysis

Complete top-to-bottom analysis of Sweet Home Chicago using all 8 modules: zone map, NCT types identified, chord change behaviors labeled, tension arc plotted, balance sheet scored. Write a one-paragraph summary of what makes this melody work. Compare to Day 11's basic analysis.

ANALYSIS

D90 The Instinct Test

Put away all sheets. Sit at your instrument. Improvise a 30-second melody over a I-IV-V-I chord progression. Afterward — without playing it back — describe what zones you visited, what your highest note was, how you handled each chord change. If you can describe it, you've internalized it.

REVIEW

MILESTONES — HOW YOU KNOW IT'S WORKING



Day 7 — Sing the ladder cold in < 5 seconds

DO-SO-MI-LA-RE-TI-FA forward and backward without hesitation. This is your first real checkpoint.



Day 14 — Draw the zone map from memory

All 4 zones, both axis labels, all 7 notes placed correctly. Under 90 seconds.



Day 30 — Label any note's zone over a static chord in < 3 seconds

The Phase 1 goal. Automatic zone assignment with no conscious calculation.



Day 45 — Hear a chord change and predict the zone shift

Before looking at the sheet, you can say: "if the chord moves from C to F and I'm holding RE, I go from Zone 3 to Zone 1."



Day 60 — Full verse analysis in real time while singing

Sing Sweet Home Chicago and internally track zones and chord tones simultaneously — no pausing to think.



Day 90 — The Instinct Test passes

You improvise a melody and can describe it using AMF language without playing it back. The framework has become the ear.

THE THREE QUESTIONS TO ASK EVERY TIME YOU WRITE A MELODY

Where is the tension in this phrase — and is it where I want it?

Does the landing note resolve, or does it leave the listener reaching for more?

If I described this phrase's zone arc out loud, would it match what the song needs emotionally?